

Tank Care Buddy

Changelog — Pre-Xcode Stabilization Pass

Session date:	Saturday, June 13, 2026
Versions shipped:	v20260613c → v20260613g (5 commits)
Branch:	main
Repo:	jtsmith7234-rgb/tank-care-buddy
Final commit:	f9b0afa
App version at close:	v20260613g
GitHub Pages:	jtsmith7234-rgb.github.io/tank-care-buddy

Overview

This session delivered a full pre-Xcode stabilization and improvement pass addressing 21 notes organized into 5 phases. All 5 phases were executed and committed to main. The app is ready for personal final testing on GitHub Pages before opening in Xcode.

Phase	Version	Commit	Description	Done
1 — Core Bugs	v20260613c	c7ae47f	10 core bugs and broken interactions fixed	✓
2 — New Tank Flow	v20260613d	bf01819	Creation form, bridging modal, Up Next placeholder	✓
3 — Guided Exp.	v20260613e	ef94b87	Contextual nav prompts, stage flash, completion	✓
4 — Smarter Logic	v20260613f	3dc8abb	Tank-kind water ranges, fish add UX, eq hints	✓
5 — Final Polish	v20260613g	f9b0afa	History grouping, Up Next copy, tab pills, empty states	✓

Phase 1 — Core Bugs · v20260613c · c7ae47f

Settings sheet scroll

Modal sheet became flex-column scrollable via CSS :has(.settings-sheet) rule.

Chemicals picker scroll

#chem-picker-list gets overflow-y:auto; max-height:45vh — no more overflow cutoff.

Water change calc

Number(t.gallons) coercion added before all water-change math; NaN divide was silently zeroing results.

Equipment not populating after add

view.tab = 'equipment' set before render() call so the Equipment tab is active and visible immediately after addItem().

Inspect does nothing

New Inspect modal added inside _openEqMoreModal with item guidance text + 'Mark inspected' action calling EQ.markServiced().

Checklist bounce

Optimistic DOM update on .ft-check click; full re-render only fires on stage auto-complete, eliminating visible list bounce.

Reminder time cutoff

flex-shrink:0; white-space:nowrap added to .rem-interval so time text never wraps or clips.

Tab icon alignment

.tab gets display:flex; align-items/justify-content:center for consistent icon centering across skins.

Phase 2 — New Tank Creation Flow · v20260613d · bf01819

openAddTank() modal structure

Rebuilt using modal-inner / modal-scroll-body / modal-footer pattern, consistent with all other long modals.

New optional fields

Substrate, Décor, and Notes added inside a collapsible block labeled 'More details (optional)' — zero friction for quick setup.

Equipment prompt bridge modal

openEquipmentPromptModal(tank) fires after guided tank creation. Two actions: 'Add equipment now' or 'Add later'. Eliminates the drop-off gap between tank creation and first equipment log.

Up Next suppression for unconfigured guided tanks

_tankHasConfiguredReminders(t) helper added. Guided tanks with no reminders configured show a soft placeholder instead of an empty/confusing Up Next block.

Help modal copy update

Reworded to 'Setting up a new tank?' with plain explanation of the 4–6 week timeline. Button labels updated to 'Yes, guide me through it' / 'No, I know what I'm doing'.

Phase 3 — Guided New Tank Experience · v20260613e · ef94b87

Most important phase of the session. Transformed the first-tank checklist from a static list into a contextual, navigating guide that responds to each step the user completes.

FT_NAV_PROMPTS map

5 specific checklist item completions fire contextual `actionToast()` messages with a 'Go →' button that navigates to the relevant tab. Example: completing 'fill tank' shows 'Ready to add equipment? Go →' which navigates to the Equipment tab.

FT_STAGE_COMPLETE_MSGS map

Stage-completion messages for each checklist stage. The `cycle_finish` stage message includes an 'Add fish →' action that navigates to the Fish tab.

`_ftShowCompletion()`

Sets `tank.firstTank.allDone + completedAt`, logs `first_tank_complete` event, shows a tasteful completion modal. Does not re-render to a blank state.

Stage flash animation

`data-stage-key` attributes added to `.ft-stage` divs. `.ft-stage-flash-done` keyframe runs 600ms before re-render on stage auto-complete, giving visible progress feedback without jarring reflows.

Compact done banner

When `tank.firstTank.allDone === true`, the full checklist is replaced with a compact `.ft-done-banner` instead of nothing, preserving the sense of progress.

`actionToast()` function

New toast variant in `app.js` — 5-second auto-dismiss with an optional tappable action button. Used for all nav prompts in Phase 3.

`window._ftNavigateToTab()`

New global helper in `app.js`. Navigates the current tank view to any named tab. Called from `actionToast` handlers.

`onChange(null)` pattern confirmed

`FIRSTTANK.bind` callback documented: `onChange(null)` = save only, no re-render. `onChange('msg')` = save + full re-render. Used throughout Phase 3 to prevent unnecessary re-renders mid-interaction.

Phase 4 — Smarter Feature Logic · v20260613f · 3dc8abb

Tank-kind water safe ranges

`SAFE_BY_KIND` map with overrides for betta, shrimp, planted, and quarantine tank kinds. `getSafeRanges(tank)` returns the correct range object. All `rateReading()` call sites updated to pass the result.

`rateReading()` updated

Now accepts an optional third parameter (safe ranges object). Backward-compatible — call sites without the argument fall back to previous defaults.

Water test 'Normal ranges' display

The ranges shown in the water test section now reflect the active tank's kind, not a generic freshwater default.

Fish add modal copy

h2 updated to 'Add to tank'; placeholder text updated to 'Type a fish name to see its profile, then add it'. More descriptive and less generic.

renderSpeciesInfo rich card

Now calls profileCard(f) instead of card(f) for a richer inline display when browsing fish profiles.

Equipment hint on fill/cycle_start stages

.ft-eq-hint block added to the fill and cycle_start guided stages when the tank has logged equipment. Includes a 'View equipment >' link that navigates to the Equipment tab.

Help topics expanded

6th HELP_TOPIC added: 'Tracking equipment' (7 total). Heater 'plug' do-item detail updated to mention thermometer use and the 2–3 hour stabilization wait.

Phase 5 — Final Polish + Pre-Xcode QA · v20260613g · f9b0afa

History event grouping

_groupEvents() function added inside renderHistory(). Same-day first_tank, daily_checkin, and reminder_fired events collapse into a count-badge row with expand/collapse. event-group-badge and event-group-member CSS added.

Up Next copy update

Wording updated: 'Due now — tap to go to [tab] tab'; 'Snoozed — resumes...'; daily check-in gets a sub-hint line. More specific, less generic.

Active tab pill style

.tab.active gets border-radius:20px (pill shape) in both light and dark skins. Visually cleaner active indicator.

Wording audit

'Hide' → 'Hide guide'; 'Mark as not done' → 'Undo step'. More natural, less robotic.

Empty state improvements

History empty: 'Nothing here yet' with descriptive copy explaining what will appear. Equipment empty: specific gear-list message mentioning service tracking.

Number() coercion confirmed

Number(t.gallons) coercion verified in two additional water-prefill locations to prevent NaN from entering any calculation path.

Files Modified This Session

File	Phases	Notes
app.js	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	Primary logic: all bug fixes, helpers, modals, nav prompts, grouping
firsttank.js	3, 4, 5	Guided experience, nav prompts, stage flash, completion flow
styles.css	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	CSS fixes, modal structures, flash keyframe, pill tab, empty states
index.html	All	Version bump each phase
capacitor.config.json	Wrap	Capacitor iOS wrap (prior commit v20260612b)
package.json	Wrap	Capacitor dependencies
ios/	Wrap	Full Xcode project scaffold
.gitignore	Wrap	Capacitor entries added
tests/ (6 files)	All	QA reports: phase-1 through phase-5 + capacitor-wrap
docs/changelogs/	Session	v20260612a and v20260612b PDFs committed

QA Reports Generated

- 2026-06-12-b-capacitor-wrap-report.md
- 2026-06-13-c-phase-1-core-bugs.md
- 2026-06-13-d-phase-2-new-tank-flow.md
- 2026-06-13-e-phase-3-guided-experience.md
- 2026-06-13-f-phase-4-smarter-logic.md
- 2026-06-13-g-phase-5-final-polish.md

Known Remaining Items (not blocking)

These items are low priority and do not block personal testing or Xcode submission.

ID	Description	When
S-1	Settings sheet modal lacks modal-inner/scroll-body structure (could overflow on small phones)	App Store
R-1	Google Fonts CDN falls back to SF Pro with no internet — acceptable behavior	Post-MVP
R-4	@capacitor/local-notifications needed for lock-screen push notifications	Notif. phase
L-3	expandedEventId not reset on tank switch	Anytime

L-4	APP_VERSION = '1.0' not tied to versioning system	Anytime
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Architecture Patterns (reference)

Core patterns established this session and required for future work:

Pattern	Implementation
Storage	<code>window.store.get(key) / window.store.set(key, val)</code>
Versioning	All files in index.html get <code>?v=YYYYMMDDX</code> query string
Render	<code>render() → renderTank() → body.innerHTML = renderXxx(t) then bindXxx(t)</code>
Modal	<code>openModal(html, onMount) / closeModal()</code> – onMount called with NO args
Modal-inner	Long modals: <code>modal-inner > modal-title, modal-scroll-body, modal-footer</code>
Toast	<code>toast(msg) 1.4s. actionToast(msg, label, fn) 5s with tap action [Phase 3]</code>
Tab nav	<code>window._ftNavigateToTab(tabName) [Phase 3]</code>
Water ranges	<code>getSafeRanges(tank) [Phase 4]. rateReading(metric, val, safe) updated.</code>
First tank	<code>FIRSTTANK.bind(tank, onChange). onChange(null)=save only; onChange('msg')=save+render</code>
Completion	<code>tank.firstTank.allDone === true → compact banner, checklist hidden</code>

Recommended Next Steps

1. Personal final test

Browse jtsmith7234-rgb.github.io/tank-care-buddy on iPhone. Create a new tank, run through the guided checklist, test fish add, water test with different tank kinds, check history grouping, and Up Next copy.

2. Open in Xcode

```
cd ~/path/to/tank-care-buddy/ios/App && pod install && open App.xcworkspace
```

3. Xcode setup

Set Signing Team → confirm bundle ID `com.tankcarebuddy.app` → run on simulator or physical device.

4. App Store Connect

Create app record → set Xcode Assets app icon (1024×1024 already generated) → upload via TestFlight.

5. Deferred items

Address S-1 (settings modal structure) before App Store submission. R-4 (local notifications) in a separate notification phase.